<u>Exercise 3b</u> Date:

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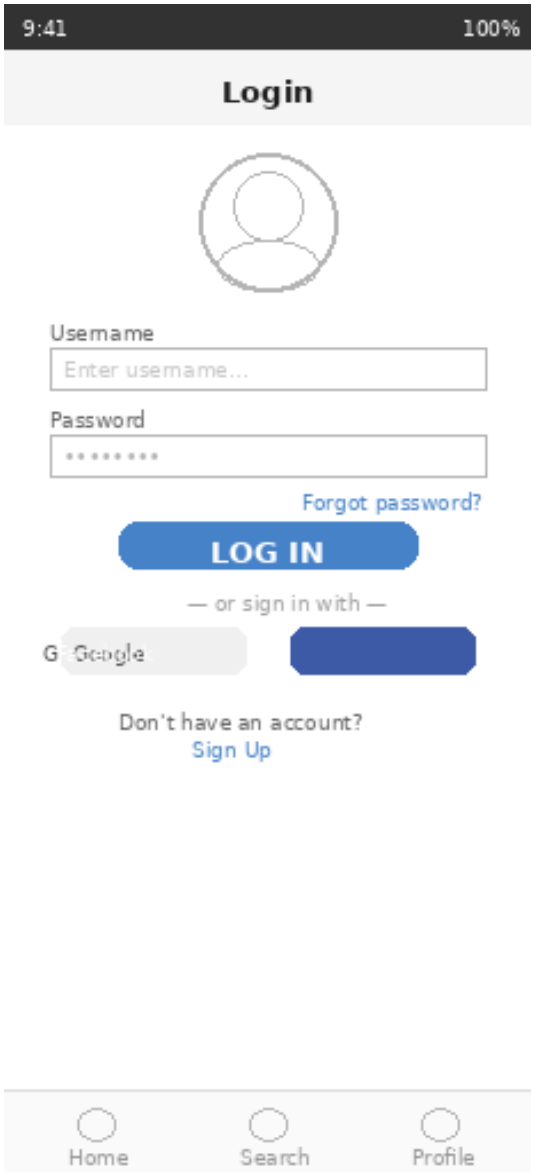
Create a prototype with familiar and unfamiliar navigation elements. Evaluate ease of use with different user groups using Wireflow.

FRAME 1:

LOGIN PAGE:



Chunking Analysis of the Login Page

The Login Page serves as the first screen users encounter in the prototype. It is designed using widely recognised authentication patterns alongside a few less

conventional elements, allowing us to observe how users from different backgrounds approach the sign-in process.

1. Purpose of the Screen
   - This screen handles user authentication and acts as the gateway to the rest of the application.
   - It helps evaluate whether users of varying technical backgrounds can complete login without assistance.

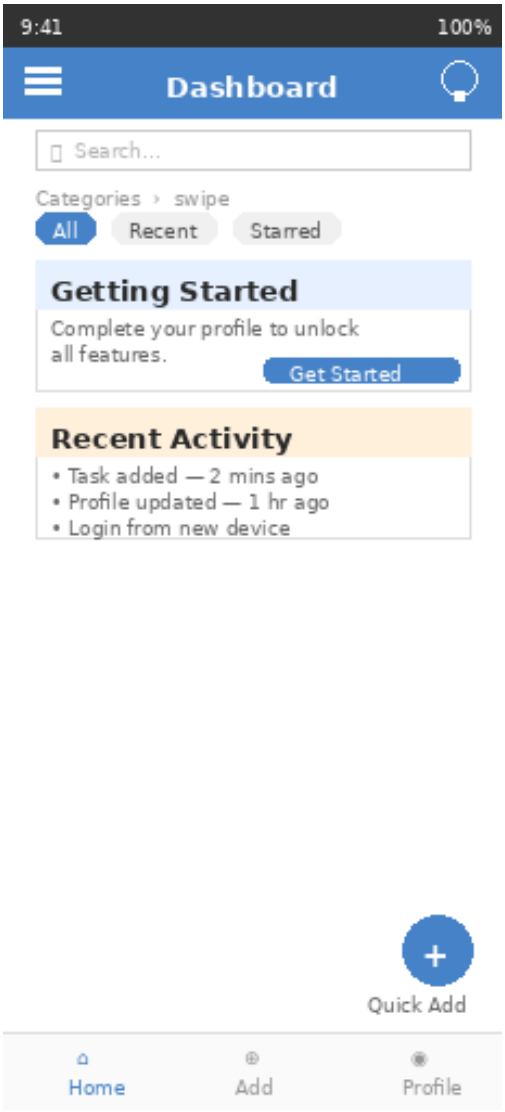
2. Key Elements and UI Components
   - Username & Password Fields –
     - Standard labelled input fields positioned vertically, matching the most common login layout.
     - Placeholder text (‘Enter username’, ‘Password’) guides users without adding clutter.
   - LOG IN Button –
     - A large, full-width blue button below the fields — the standard CTA placement familiar to all users.
   - Forgot Password Link –
     - Right-aligned text link below the password field — a familiar secondary action pattern.
   - Social Sign-In Buttons (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - Google and Facebook buttons are placed side by side below a divider — users unfamiliar with OAuth flows may not know these link to external accounts.
   - Sign Up Link –
     - A text-only link at the bottom for new users — familiar pattern but easy to overlook without a distinct button style.

3. How the Login Page Works
   1. The user types their username and password into the two labelled input fields.
   2. Tapping the LOG IN button or pressing Enter submits the credentials for verification.
   3. The user may alternatively choose a social login option to sign in without a password.
   4. New users tap ‘Sign Up’ to navigate to the registration screen.

4. Cognitive and UX Benefits

- Familiar layout reduces time-to-first-action — users recognise the form immediately.
- Keeping the screen uncluttered allows users of all skill levels to focus on the single task of signing in.
- Offering social login alternatives lowers the barrier for users who struggle to recall credentials.
- The ‘Forgot password?’ link provides a safety net, reducing anxiety around login errors.

FRAME 2:
HOME PAGE (DASHBOARD):



Chunking Analysis of the Home Page

After logging in, users are taken to the Dashboard. This screen presents a mix of conventional content layouts and novel interaction patterns to examine how quickly different user groups can find their way around.

1. Purpose of the Screen
   - The Dashboard acts as the central landing point, giving users access to search, content browsing, and activity summaries from a single screen.
   - It is used to measure how fast users can locate primary actions and whether hidden controls are found without prompting.

2. Key Elements and UI Components
   - Top Bar with Hamburger Menu (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - Three horizontal lines in the top-left conceal a full side menu. Users who have not encountered this pattern before often overlook it entirely.
     - The bell icon in the top-right corner is widely understood, though icon-only controls can still confuse users who prefer labelled buttons.
   - Search Bar –
     - A standard search input at the top of the content area — familiar to all user groups.
   - Swipeable Category Chips (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A row of filter labels that can be scrolled horizontally. Because there is no visible scroll indicator, users must discover this interaction through trial and error.
   - Content Cards –
     - Two grouped cards (‘Getting Started’ and ‘Recent Activity’) present structured information in a familiar card-layout pattern.
   - Floating Action Button / FAB (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A circular ‘+’ button floating in the bottom-right corner for a ‘Quick Add’ action. Its purpose is not obvious until tapped.
   - Bottom Navigation Bar –
     - Three-tab bar (Home, Add, Profile) at the bottom — the standard mobile navigation pattern.

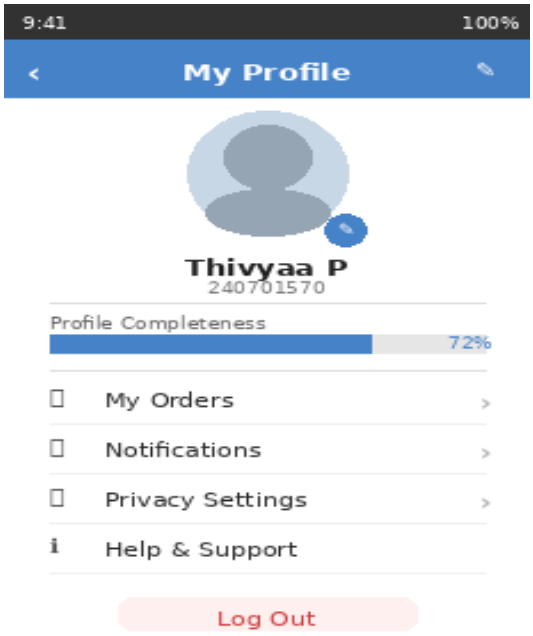
3. How the Home Page Works

1. After a successful login, the user is directed to the Dashboard automatically.
2. Tapping the three-line icon reveals a hidden drawer with the full navigation menu.
3. The user can swipe the category row left or right to reveal and select additional filters.
4. Tapping the floating button lets the user add a new item from anywhere on the Dashboard without leaving the screen.
5. The bottom navigation tabs allow the user to move between the main sections of the application.

4. Cognitive and UX Benefits

- Grouping information into cards gives each piece of content a clear visual boundary, making the page easier to scan at a glance.
- Having the navigation bar fixed at the bottom ensures users always know how to move to another section, regardless of how far they have scrolled.
- The floating action button shortens the path to the most frequent task, improving efficiency for repeat users.
- Unfamiliar elements (hamburger menu, swipeable chips) test adaptability — experienced users find them immediately, while newer users may need guidance.

FRAME 3:
PROFILE PAGE:



Chunking Analysis of the Profile Page

The Profile Page displays the user's personal information, account settings, and progress. It combines familiar list-based navigation with unfamiliar gamification and inline editing elements.

1. Purpose of the Screen
    - Users come here to review their account information, check how complete their profile is, and access sub-pages like order history and notification settings.
    - The screen is used to test whether users interact with the progress bar and the avatar edit badge unprompted, or whether these elements go unnoticed.

2. Key Elements and UI Components

- Profile Avatar with Edit Badge (Unfamiliar Element) –
  - A tiny edit icon sits in the corner of the profile picture. Because it blends into the image, many users do not notice it is interactive on their first visit to the page.
- Name and ID Display –
  - User's name and roll number displayed below the avatar — a standard profile header pattern.
- Profile Completeness Progress Bar (Unfamiliar Element) –
  - A filled bar indicates how much of the profile has been completed. While motivating, this element surprises users who expect a plain settings page without any game-like mechanics.
- List Menu Items –
  - My Orders, Notifications, Privacy Settings, and Help & Support are presented as tappable rows with right-pointing arrows — a universally familiar settings list pattern.
- Log Out Button –
  - A lightly styled red button at the bottom of the screen — familiar placement but uses color to signal a destructive action.

3. How the Profile Page Works

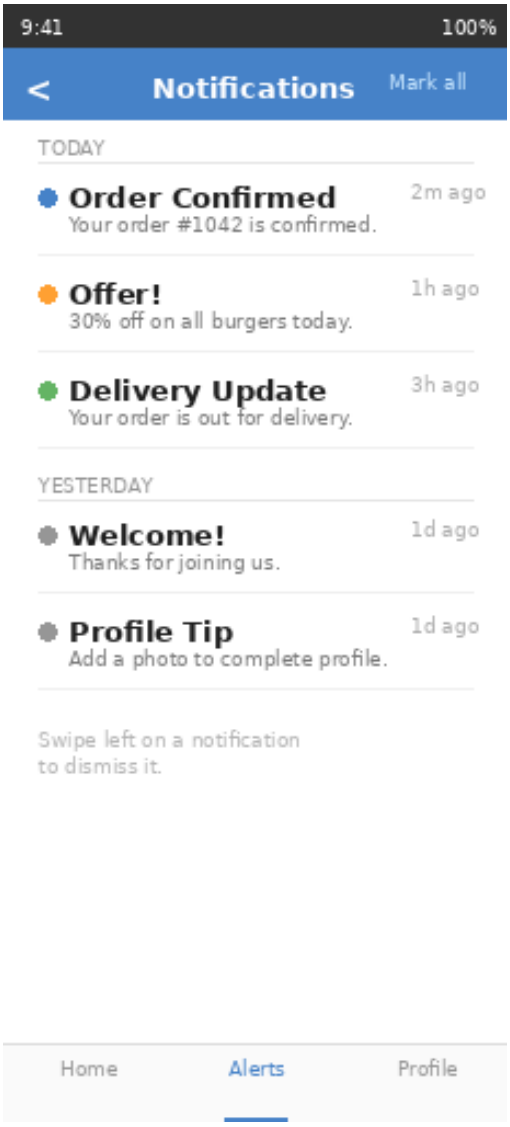
1. The user sees their avatar, name, and ID number at the top of the page as soon as they open the Profile screen.
2. Tapping the small pencil badge on the avatar opens a photo picker for updating the profile picture.
3. The user can review the completeness bar and tap on incomplete sections to fill them in and raise the percentage.
4. Each menu row is tappable and navigates the user to the relevant sub-page.
5. Tapping the Log Out button ends the current session and redirects the user back to the Login screen.

4. Cognitive and UX Benefits

- Displaying profile completion as a percentage bar gives users a clear, measurable goal and motivates them to complete their account setup.
- Placing all account options in one vertical list means users can find any setting with a single scroll, without hunting through multiple screens.

- The disclosure arrows on each row immediately communicate that tapping will open a new screen, aligning with the expectation users already have from other apps.
- The Log Out button's red colouring communicates its destructive nature without requiring a label change.

FRAME 4:
NOTIFICATIONS PAGE:



Chunking Analysis of the Notifications Page

The Notifications Page organises system messages and updates in a time-sorted list. It blends a conventional grouped list layout with a swipe gesture that is

invisible until discovered, making it a useful screen for testing gesture literacy across user groups.

1. Purpose of the Screen
   - The page gathers all recent system messages into a single, time-ordered feed so users can review and act on updates without searching through the application.
   - It specifically tests whether users attempt the swipe-to-dismiss gesture on their own, or whether they rely solely on the visible 'Mark all' control.

2. Key Elements and UI Components
   - Top Bar with Back Arrow and 'Mark All' (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A standard back arrow returns the user to the previous screen — familiar across all platforms.
     - The 'Mark all' text button in the top-right is a compact action that less experienced users may not notice or understand.
   - Time-Grouped Sections (TODAY / YESTERDAY) –
     - Separating notifications into TODAY and YESTERDAY sections gives users an immediate sense of recency and makes the feed much easier to navigate than a continuous undivided list.
   - Notification Rows with Colour-Coded Dots –
     - Each unread notification has a coloured dot (blue, orange, green) indicating category — a visual chunking cue that speeds up scanning.
     - Within each notification row, the bold title, smaller descriptive text, and right-aligned timestamp form a clean three-level hierarchy that guides the eye naturally.
   - Swipe-to-Dismiss Gesture (Unfamiliar Element) –
     - A faint hint text ('Swipe left on a notification to dismiss it') introduces a gesture-based action. Users unfamiliar with swipe gestures may rely solely on the 'Mark all' button instead.
   - Active Tab Indicator –
     - The bottom navigation highlights the Alerts tab with a coloured underline — a familiar active-state pattern.

3. How the Notifications Page Works
   1. The user opens the Notifications page by tapping the Alerts tab in the bottom navigation bar.

2. The user scans the TODAY section first, using the coloured dots to identify which notifications need immediate attention.
3. To remove a single notification, the user swipes it to the left, which reveals a dismiss action.
4. User taps ‘Mark all’ to clear all unread notifications at once.
5. When finished, the user taps the back arrow to return to whichever screen they navigated from.

4. Cognitive and UX Benefits

- Dividing the feed by time period means users can immediately jump to relevant alerts rather than reading every item from the top.
- The category dots let users filter visually before engaging with any text, significantly cutting down the time needed to process the list.
- The swipe-to-dismiss gesture rewards experienced mobile users with an efficient interaction, while the ‘Mark all’ fallback ensures usability for all groups.
- The small instructional hint at the bottom of the list lowers the learning curve for the unfamiliar gesture, making the interaction accessible without cluttering the screen with a permanent label.